The National Archives reference FO 17/674

Confidential

Cl. 116

Peking
22. June 1874.

My Lord,

In continuation of the foregoing Despatch of this date, I have the honour to lay before Your Lordship the plan of the project therein reported.

I mentioned in my Despatch, No. 99. of the 10th June that the High-Commissioner, Shên Pao-chên appointed to settle matters in Formosa, would probably be assisted by M. Giquel, the able Frenchman, lately director of the Arsenal

the Earl of Derby

Peking - 22 June.
Rec'd Wade.
No. 115

Rec'd Sept. 7
per Mail

China should buy British Iron Plant
Proposal unfavorable
Assistance invited under certain conditions
Ans'd by Tel. Sept. 8.

Mr. Disraeli

Mr. Wade not to be disposed to entertain such a proposal at present.
405 We have very long

refused to concern in the sale by the Admiralty of an unsuitable to the Defence grounds, and have in general their gates to that effect: I think therefore we are bound to deal in the same way with the Chinese party in the existing case.

D.

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference —
F.O. 17 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

Consul at Tamsui

M. Giquel, as M. de Geofroy — informs me, has received from him a caution not to render War-service to the Chinese; a caution only, - for there is not yet, nor is there likely to be, a declaration of War. Governed as the French are, however, such a caution is tantamount to a prohibition. - M. de Geofroy has laid this restriction on M. Giquel because he wishes to see the Japanese succeed in Formosa and has hopes of

of their success.

M. Giquel is trusted by the Chinese whom he has served as a very efficient ally, and he has very early come to the conclusion, which since the Japanese began to act has been equally my own, that, in the end, the Japanese will have to give way in Formosa. I have no doubt therefore that he is in full possession of the plans of the High Commissioner, and there he informs me are, in brief, as follows -

The plea for action on the side of

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

of Japan being the murder of
shipwrecked Loochoowans in past
years, the Commissioner will endeavor
through the reclaimed Formosans
who recognize the rule of China, to
induce the unreclaimed Tribes to
engage no more to molest shipwrecked
people - This effected, he will invite
the Japanese to withdraw. If they
refuse, the case between China
and Japan will be referred either
to foreign Ministers at Pekin or to
other arbitration - For its defence
meanwhile the Chinese Government
requires

requires an iron-clad, and according
to M. Giquel, we have a Monitor
borne on our estimates as worth
one hundred and thirty thousand
pounds Sterling, which would exactly
suit the Chinese. The Commissioner,
he says, has moved the Yamên to
request my support of the proposal
to buy this Vessel.

130,000

I enclose copy of M. Giquel's
confidential letter and of the reply
I have draughted to him today -
- In this it will be seen that I
refer

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference
F.O. 17 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

refer to advocacy of the project —
otherwise than through this Legation
as inadmissable. I shall explain
what this means in a separate —
Despatch, as also M. Giquel's allusion
to the possible mission of some —
Chinese to England for the purpose
of learning navigation &c.

M. Giquel addresses himself to me,
no doubt as the fit person to apply
to in a case which concerns the British
Government, the only Government
he appears, possessing such a Craft as

China

China requires, but I imagine that he
comes to me, also, because he has every
reason not to expect the support of
his own Minister at this moment
M. de Geofroy, as I shall elsewhere
report, is seriously at issue with the
Chinese Government on Missionary
questions.

The Americans must be able, I
should think, to let the Chinese
have such a Ship as they want as
easily as we; but the promotion
of this enterprise against Formosa

by

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE Reference — F.O. 17 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

by M. Legendre, and other Americans has not been explained to the satisfaction of the Chinese, and although the Yamen can have no doubt of the rectitude or friendliness of Dr. Williams, the present Chargé d'Affaires, the proceedings of his countrymen in Japan have excited a certain misgiving here.

I am endeavoring to set before your Lordship all that I think has a bearing on the case before me. It is quite possible that the Yamen will, after all, content itself

itself with indirect enquiries, such as the Governor General Li has now been making. The dread of being asked for a counter conception will, as likely as not, scare it from a straightforward application.

The Chinese have besides the profoundest faith in luck. Their luck in the Japanese affair has been so far better than they would have expected, and, as usual, they will run many risks before they ask a favor

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
F.O. 17 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

favor of a foreign Government.

I have the honor to be
with the highest respect,
My Lord,
Your Lordship's most obedient,
Humble servant,
Thomas Francis Wade.

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference —
F.O. 17 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

Peking – 22 June

Mr Wade

No 116 confidential

2 Encl.

rec^d Sept. 7.

Story of Iron-clad

Project.

EI

Mr Dinsdale

D

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

Fou tcheou le 3 Juin 1874

Mon cher Monsieur Wade

Je viens vous demander votre bon vouloir pour une question où l'un de mes amis vient de s'engager par suite d'un ordre de Peking.

Je veux parler du Commissaire Impérial de l'arsenal, Shen pao-chen, qui vient de charger de regler la question de Formose. Le plan qu'il veut suivre consisterait à epuiser avec les

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference :— F.O. 17 . 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

les Japonais toutes les négotiations possibles basées sur le droit international et les traités conclus entre la Chine et le Japon. Il va se rendre à Formose dans quelques jours; au moyen des aborigènes soumis à l'autorité Chinoise il tâchera de réunir les chefs des tribus sauvages, de les faire s'engager par contrat à respecter à l'avenir les gens qui iront faire naufrage sur leurs côtes; ceci fait, et il croit y arriver, il pourra signifier aux Japonais que le

but

but de leur expedition est rempli, et qu'ils n'ont plus qu'à se retirer. Si les Japonais s'y refusent, la question serait soumise à un arbitrage des Ministres residents à Peking ou de tels hauts personnages que les deux parties pourraient désigner.

Vous voyez, mon cher Monsieur Wade, qu'en agissant ainsi la Chine aura fait tout son possible pour éviter un recours aux armes. Toutefois, comme la manière de faire des

Japonais

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference —
F.O. 17 . 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

Japon ne permet pas de certifier que les moyens paisibles aboutiront, Shen se propose de faire quelques preparatifs de défense parmi lesquels l'achat d'un bâtiment cuirassé, si le Gouvernement Anglais veut bien le céder à la Chine.

Vous savez dans vos ports la seule espèce de bâtiments qui puisse convenir à la Chine, c'est un monitor du type "Gorgon", "Hecate" et "Cyclops". Il cale 16 pieds, seul tirant d'eau qui permette à un

bâtiment

bâtiment blindé d'entrer dans les ports de la Chine et de se faire reparer dans ses docks. En haussant les plats-bords, un tel bâtiment peut tenir la mer et naviguer facilement sur les côtes de Chine. Son prix sur les tables de l'Amirauté est marqué 130,000 livres Sterling. Shen a demandé au Tsong li Yamên de solliciter votre appui pour que le Gouvernement Anglais consentit à vendre un pareil navire à la Chine, et à le faire conduire en

Chine

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference —
F.O. 17 . 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

Chine par un personnel d'officiers
et de matelots qui serait renvoyé
en Angleterre, une fois le navire
rendu à destination. Il est fort
probable que la Chine enverra
des officiers et des matelots
jusqu'en Angleterre pour faire
partie de l'équipage et à apprendre
durant le voyage à se servir
du navire en question. Ce serait
si cette dernière idée est mise
à exécution un pas très marqué
de la Chine vers l'Europe.
Si vous accédiez à la demande
des Chinois, vous pourriez sans

doute

doute télégraphier votre opinion
au Gouvernement Anglais, de
façon que l'achat du bâtiment
et son expédition puissent être
conclus par telegraphe et se regler
le plus vite possible. Il n'y a
pas de temps à perdre pour
opérer cette transaction pendant
que la Chine est encore en paix
avec les autres puissances.

Un de nos bâtiments
qui est allé il y a quelques jours
conduire près des Japonais un
Brei-yuan du Taotai de Formose
rapporte que ce Mandarin a été
bien reçu par les chefs des troupes.

Mais

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference —
F.O. 17 . 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

mais que ceux ci ont refusé — d'engager aucune discussion avec lui, alléguant que toutes les raisons de Japon devaient se donner à Peking et pas ailleurs. Il y avait parmi les trompes cinq ou six officiers Américains, parmi lesquels l'officier de marine Cassel et un Colonel du Génie. Il y avait des Américains comme capitaines et mécaniciens à bord de quatres navires qui étaient au mouillage de Langkiao.

Cette expedition des Japonais est une aventure organisée et conduite par des flibustiers Américains.

Américains. Il y a eu quelques jours avant la visite du Ouaiguen un engagement entre les Japonais et les sauvages; ceux-ci ont tué et décapité un Japonais qui errait hors des campements; les trompes ont marché sur les sauvages, en ont tué 30, et ont eu elles-mêmes 4 tués, et 14 blessés. Comme je vais aller faire prochainement un tour à Formose, je vous tiendrai très volontiers au courant de ce que j'aurai vu, si cela peut vous intéresser.

Veuillez, mon cher Monsieur

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE Reference — F.O. 17 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

Monsieur Wade, trop ami de la justice, pour que j'ai dans cette circonstance à plaider devant vous la cause des Chinois. J'ai donc confiance en votre appui, aussi bien dans l'arbitrage qu'ils pourront mettre entre vos mains, que dans votre assistance pour les quelques mesures militaires qu'ils veulent prendre, et qu'ils ont certainement eu tort de ne pas prendre plutôt. L'Angleterre qui ne veut pas conquérir en Chine ne laissera pas donner le mauvais exemple

de

de la conquête sur ce pays par le Japon qui a procédé dans ce cas contre les droit des gens et les traités ! Elle a trop fait pour convaincre les Chinois de sa justice pour ne pas les soutenir devant l'acte — injustifiable d'hostilité dont ils sont victimes.

Présentez &c &c

(Signed) Prosper Jiquel

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference —
F.O. 17
674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

Peking
22 June 1874

Mon cher M. Giquel

Thank the pleasure to receive your note of the 3rd instant a few days ago. It is full of interest and I thank you beforehand for the further information which it promises me regarding affairs in Formosa.

Politically I think that the Chinese have shown their sense in the decision which

J.

Copy
M. Giquel
to
Mr. Wade
Confidential

Enclosure
No 1
in Mr. Wade's
No. 116

of 22 June
1874

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference —
F.O. 17 . 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

I understand you to say has been taken, to attempt the recovery of Formosa by diplomacy. I believe that your friend, the High Commissioner Shên, is an able man and I hope that he may see his way to making the island more available than it now is to foreign trade. This will be its best guarantee against absorption by Japan or by any other power.

As to the vessel of war which you say is essential to the

the Empire for defensive purposes, the Yamên has not spoken yet. On the other hand I hear that outside Chinese are sounding British subjects of no responsibility as to the possible views of the British Government. The British Government would certainly not entertain the proposition until my opinion had been taken. Indirect negotiations therefore would do no good and might perhaps do harm. It would be well that

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE Reference :— F.O. 17 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

that the Chinese should understand this.

If the Yamên do propose the purchase to me I shall not hesitate to recommend the British Government to entertain the proposition. As to the other part of the scheme, I mean the education of Chinese Officers and Seamen, I have given my adhesion in the note in which I returned you Captain Tracy's letter. I cannot pretend to commit my Government, but Treaty

Can

can imagine no great difficulty about either part of their project, if the Chinese will only act towards us with comparative frankness.

Your note of the 3rd was confidential and I must beg you so to regard this answer.

(Signed) T. F. Wade

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE Reference — F.O. 17 . 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
Reference :—
F.O. 17 674
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

The National Archives reference FO 17/674

(0: 1 2)

Copy

Mr. Wade
to
M. Jequier
Private

Enclosure
No 2
in Mr. Wade's
No 116

---

of 22 June
1874